

open. When I reached there, I found the line-up dominated with models from Philips, LG, Sony and also Moserbaer. There were a few models from Intex and the more exotic Pioneer.

Browsing first by the price tags, I noticed that the cheaper models were from Intex and Moserbaer. The most priciest ones were from Sony and Samsung. You would expect the cheaper models to not have as many features as the Samsung and Sony models, but you would be wrong. The Moserbaer MBI6988G was one really impressive model. It had most of the feature set of the costlier Samsung and Sony models, but at half the price. This particular model was just Rs. 2,350 – way lower than the price range I had set out to buy a DVD player.

The local salesman who was watching me headed in my direction with the hope of changing my mind. He first tried to push me to either of two Intex models. Those two models were some Rs. 400 more than the Moserbaer, but with similar features and slightly inferior build quality.

For those wondering over what these features are that I've been going on about, I'm talking about the ability to play DivX video and MP3 audio playback at the least. Ability to read from USB as well as memory cards is an added bonus. You can't really be burning DVDs or CDs for every video or movie you want to watch. The USB connectivity makes life much simpler. Simply plug in an external hard drive or use one of your USB flash drives to play movies off it. The memory card reading should cover all standard formats – SD, MMC and preferably also memory stick.

The HDMI connector is another handy feature to have, especially if you use a LCD or plasma TV. That's something I wish the Moserbaer MBI 6988G had. The HDMI option means I just need to connect one single cable for audio and video – it even gives me perfect audio and video quality! Eventually, I had to settle with component cables. Speaking of which, make sure the player that you buy comes bundled with these cables or your next stop will be another electronics store and not your living room. If you end up with a model that has HDMI, remember that you'll have to spend at least Rs. 400 for a decent 2-m long HDMI cable.

One of the salesmen also tried to emphasise that some of these models had 1080p and 1080i support. It didn't look like he knew what these terms meant or what the differences were,



Panasonic DMP-BD60